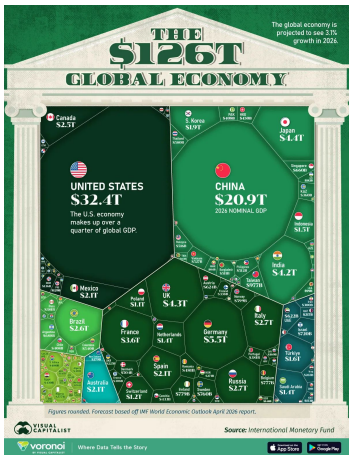


The \$126 Trillion Global Economy — Beyond a Snapshot

The Original



Critique

Strengths

- Vivid — draws readers into a large dataset
- Region colour — shows continental clusters

Weaknesses (→ what we fixed)

- Areashard to compare precisely → ranked bars
- Small economies unlabelled → top-15 + labels
- Mixed units billions & trillions → one unit
- One year cannot show the Asia shift → time series

References



Introduction

In 2026 the world economy is projected at about **\$126 trillion**, but output is highly concentrated and its centre of gravity is moving. Knowing where economic weight sits, how it is shifting between regions, and which economies are wealthy *per person* informs trade, investment, and policy decisions — patterns a single-year treemap cannot show.

Design Brief

Audience: economic and trade-policy analysts prioritising global markets and partnerships.

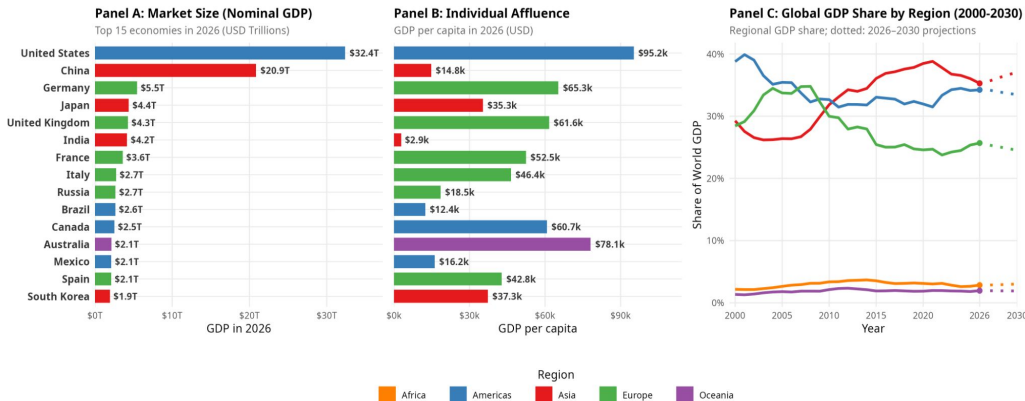
Task: rank and compare the absolute market size of economies in 2026, and reveal the shift of economic weight toward Asia since 2000.

Revisions: side-by-side ranked bars for GDP and GDP per capita; a line chart of regional share over time; a colour-blind-safe one-hue-per-region palette; standardised units (USD trillions).

Our Redesign

Redesigning the Global Economy: Market Size, Trends, and Individual Affluence

A comparison of the world's top 15 economies (2026) and regional GDP share (2000-2030)



Data

IMF WEO (Apr 2026) — nominal GDP (NGDPD) ·
World Bank — population (SP.POP.TOTL). Cleaned in Quarto/R: dropped aggregate rows, standardised ISO-3 codes & regions, converted to USD trillions, merged population. **190 economies; 2026 total \$125.7T.**

References

IMF WEO (Apr 2026); World Bank WDI; Visual Capitalist (2026); Okabe & Ito (2008). Full report & code → QR.